

June

18

618

Tang emperor

After the fall of the Sui Dynasty in China, official Li Yuan seized power and founded the Tang Dynasty, ruling as Emperor Gaozu. The dynasty he established lasted three centuries.



Born this day

1942 Paul McCartney, British singer and musician. One of the two principal songwriters in the legendary band The Beatles, he went on to have a successful solo career. He has won 18 Grammy Awards and more than 30 of his songs have topped the US Billboard Hot 100 chart.

Also on this day

1429 Under Joan of Arc's inspirational leadership, French forces defeated the English army in the Battle of Patay, during the Hundred Years' War.

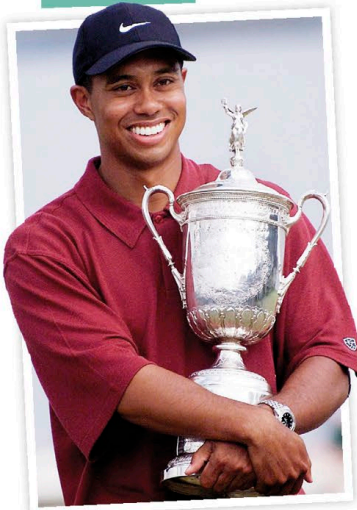
1940 French army officer **Charles de Gaulle** gave a rousing speech urging the people of France to resist the Nazi occupation of their country.

1980 **Shakuntala Devi**, an Indian mathematician known as the "human computer", mentally multiplied two random 13-digit numbers in just 28 seconds.

2000

Greatest golfer

US golfer **Tiger Woods** won the 100th US Open Championship at Pebble Beach, California, USA, by a record-breaking 15 strokes.



1815 Battle of Waterloo

After a string of conquests in Europe, French emperor **Napoleon Bonaparte** was finally defeated in a battle near Waterloo, in present-day Belgium, by a combined force of British, Dutch, and German soldiers. Both sides made heavy use of cannon fire.

